Berlin Wall of prominent historical recall (and later post-1989 salvage) included over 45,000 individual concrete segments with L-shaped bases, smooth surfaces, and coats of light paint, which when lined up in sprawling sequence made for a compelling canvas ripe for artists and commenters from the West.[43]

Tajiri, too, returned to reimagine the scale of the Wall shortly after his ground survey. The frustration evident in his final images led to a varied mode of visual observation. In 1972, with the permission of the Berlin senate, Tajiri flew over the city and captured a continuous, twenty-minute film of the Wall while he was strapped into a British "Sioux" helicopter. His idea was both conceptual and attentive to pragmatics of the border. He filmed from 200 meters away from the border, 200 meters in the sky, and with 200 meters of Sony Portapak tape held in a connected rigged backpack. Tajiri again attempted to see the Wall as one long sculpture. The footage, low-resolution by today's standards, was a technological achievement for its time, not to mention a feat of geopolitical balance. Tajiri uses a transcendent media: he could temporarily overcome the Wall and pursue a scope unimaginable from the ground. He makes the Wall, the border system, and the landforms around on both sides visible as a continuous set of interlocked structures. But rising above the earth, he misses the rich detail he achieved during his wandering through the city. Despite the poetry of flying above Berlin's wall, the distance is lacking in what the photos offered: an attention to close-up form, as well as the disruptions, variations, sublimated violence, and broader contexts of what division wrought on the terrain of the city.

Three years after Tajiri self-published his *The Wall Die Mauer Le Mur* in 1971, he resumed work with his negatives of the Wall survey. He began to produce daguerreotypes using a nineteenth-century photochemical practice that produced ghostly keepsakes, a process nearly as antiquated as the notion of a walled city itself. He fashioned nearly 100 small daguerreotypes in an alchemic process; six featured scenes by the Wall, including images of Checkpoint Charlie and the Brandenburg Gate.[44] Tajiri ended this experiment with daguerreotypes after a doctor advised him of potential mercury poisoning. In this iteration of the project, his Wall visions are self-evident artistic oddities, unwieldy and precious objects. They propose a renewed reading of the Wall by producing its likeness as an artifact, more rarified than the palm-sized self-published book. After making these daguerreotypes, Tajiri put his negatives in storage. He lacked the immediate